

Phoenix Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
620 W Washington Street, Phoenix, AZ 85003

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(602) 555-0177 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	PPD-26-07-19-3341	WEATHER	Haboob / Dust Storm (visibility near zero, approx. 30 ft)
DATE OF INCIDENT	July 19, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Daylight — darkened by dust
TIME OF INCIDENT	15:09 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Dry / Dust-covered
LOCATION	I-10 Eastbound, Milepost 151.3 (Chandler Blvd overpass area), Chandler, AZ 85225	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	5-vehicle chain rear-end — haboob zero-visibility pileup / 5 vehicles

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	Phoenix Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Daniel E. Vargas, Badge #8819
Officer Phone	(602) 555-0177 ext. 718
EMS Agency	Chandler Fire Dept. — Medic 271 and Medic 276 (transported four occupants)
Tow Companies	Desert Eagle Towing (V2, V4, V5); owner (V1, V3)
Additional Units	Sgt. B. Thornton #4412; ADOT Incident Response; AHP Unit 7-C

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2022 Jeep Wrangler	1C4HJXFG4NW041801	AZ-HTR-441 (AZ)	Rear bumper deformed; tow hook bent — minor; drivable
V2	2020 Kia Telluride	5XYP5DHC0LG341801	AZ-JLX-224 (AZ)	Front and rear deformed — sandwiched; both airbags deployed; dust infiltration
V3	2018 Toyota Tacoma	3TMCZ5AN5JM339801	AZ-KBW-881 (AZ)	Front bumper destroyed; hood crumple; airbag deployed; coolant loss
V4	2021 Chevrolet Equinox	3GNAXKEV1MS441801	AZ-LCM-773 (AZ)	Front end destroyed; airbag deployed; hood buckled; total loss probable
V5	2019 Ram 1500	1C6SRFMT0KN441801	AZ-MPT-558 (AZ)	Front bumper, grille, hood deformed; airbag deployed; drivable under caution

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	Linh T. Nguyen	02/14/1987	AZ-N44218301	None
Driver V2	Gregory R. Fletcher	09/03/1979	AZ-F88234107	AZ ARS §28-730 — Following Too Close
Driver V3	Carmen R. Orozco	05/27/1994	AZ-O77187213	AZ ARS §28-730 — Following Too Close
Driver V4	Victor M. Castillo	08/11/1990	AZ-C44219801	AZ ARS §28-730 — Following Too Close; AZ ARS §28-701 — Failure to Reduce Speed for Hazardous Conditions
Driver V5	Denise A. Banks	12/22/1983	AZ-B88219812	None

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Sharon L. Fletcher	11/08/1981	Serious: cervical fracture (suspected), airbag burns, loss of consciousness	Yes — CFD Medic 271, to Banner Desert Medical Center (trauma activation)
V2	Tyler G. Fletcher	03/17/2009	Moderate: forehead laceration, arm bruising	Yes — CFD Medic 271, to Phoenix Childrens Hospital (stable)
V4	Isabel F. Castillo	07/22/1993	Serious: rib fractures (x3), airbag facial burns, shoulder contusion	Yes — CFD Medic 276, to Banner Desert Medical Center (serious)
V3	Ernesto P. Orozco	04/05/1996	Moderate: neck pain, left arm laceration	Yes — CFD Medic 276, to Chandler Regional Medical Center (stable)
V1	None	—	Driver Nguyen — minor dust-related eye irritation; evaluated on scene	No

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Raymond T. Ellison	Motorist stopped under Chandler Blvd overpass before haboob hit	(480) 555-0341	Yes — observed haboob wall advance from west; confirmed near-zero visibility; written statement
W2	Sandra K. Moreno	Overpass pedestrian, above incident location	(480) 555-0448	Yes — watched from above as vehicles disappeared into dust; observed collision sounds; verbal statement
W3	ADOT Incident Response Supervisor	ADOT District 6 Operations	(480) 555-0512	Yes — confirmed DMS at Milepost 148 was activating "DUST STORM — PULL ASIDE" at time of incident; supplemental ADOT log provided
W4	Warren P. Childress	Following vehicle, stopped safely	(480) 555-0617	Yes — states he pulled over and activated hazards as soon as visibility dropped; confirmed V5 did not stop; written statement

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

	I-10 EB mile marker sign post at 151.0 — struck by V4 during collision slide; post bent. ADOT notified.
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SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Sunday July 19, 2026 at approximately 15:09 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Thornton, Arizona Department of Transportation Incident Response, and Arizona Highway Patrol Unit 7-C were dispatched to I-10 eastbound at Milepost 151.3 near the Chandler Boulevard overpass on report of a five-vehicle chain collision with multiple injuries. A haboob (dust storm) had advanced rapidly from the west at the time of the incident, reducing visibility to approximately 30 feet in the collision zone. The roadway surface was dry but heavily coated with fine dust and airborne debris. V1 (2022 Jeep Wrangler, Nguyen) recognized the approaching haboob wall and decelerated to a near-stop, activating hazard lights. V2 (2020 Kia Telluride, Fletcher) was traveling directly behind V1 and failed to reduce speed in time within the near-zero visibility conditions, striking V1's rear at an estimated 40 mph. V2 came to an angled stop partially blocking the center and right lanes. V3 (2018 Toyota Tacoma, Orozco) struck the rear of V2 with significant force; the airbag in V3 deployed. V4 (2021 Chevrolet Equinox, Castillo) struck V3's rear at a higher estimated speed — witness Warren Childress, who had stopped safely under the overpass, described V4 as appearing to be traveling at near-normal highway speed entering the dust cloud without apparent braking. V4 was pushed into V3 and V3 into V2, resulting in a three-stage compression. V5 (2019 Ram 1500, Banks) was following V4 at a greater distance and was able to brake to a low speed before making contact with V4's rear, adding a fifth unit to the chain. ADOT Incident Response confirmed that the dynamic message sign at Milepost 148.2 (approximately 3.1 miles west of the collision point) began displaying "DUST STORM — PULL ASIDE, STAY ALIVE" at 15:04 hrs — five minutes before the collision. All five drivers passed Milepost 148.2 within this window. Witness Raymond Ellison, stopped under the Chandler Blvd overpass before the haboob arrived, confirmed the dust wall's leading edge was visually apparent from a distance of approximately 0.5 miles before it obscured all visibility. V2 passenger Sharon Fletcher was found unresponsive with suspected cervical fracture and was transported by Chandler FD Medic 271 to Banner Desert Medical Center under trauma activation. V2 passenger Tyler Fletcher, age 16, was transported to Phoenix Children's Hospital with facial laceration. V4 passenger Isabel Castillo was transported to Banner Desert Medical Center with three rib fractures and airbag burns. V3 passenger Ernesto Orozco was transported to Chandler Regional Medical Center with neck pain and arm laceration. Driver Nguyen reported dust-related eye irritation and was evaluated on scene. All remaining drivers were uninjured.

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — HABOOB DOCUMENTATION AND ADOT COORDINATION: The haboob event on July 19, 2026 was a documented meteorological event. National Weather Service Phoenix issued a Dust Storm Warning at 14:52 hrs for the Chandler/Gilbert corridor. NWS Phoenix has been requested to provide the official advisory timeline, radar data, and visibility estimates for the Milepost 148–155 segment for the period 14:50–15:30 hrs. ADOT District 6 Operations Center confirmed the following DMS activations on I-10 EB prior to the collision: - Milepost 148.2 DMS: "DUST STORM — PULL ASIDE STAY ALIVE" — activated 15:04 hrs - Milepost 133.0 DMS (farther west): "DUST STORM AHEAD REDUCE SPEED" — activated 14:57 hrs ADOT has provided a log extract (ADOT DMS Log #D6-2026-0719-11) which is attached as Exhibit A. All five drivers passed Milepost 148.2 within the advisory window. AZ PULL ASIDE STAY ALIVE LAW: AZ ARS §28-775 requires motorists encountering a dust storm to exit the roadway, turn off lights, and remain until conditions improve. All five drivers are noted to have remained on the roadway; however, only Driver V4 Castillo has been cited, as V4's speed entering the dust cloud was demonstrably non-compliant with ARS §28-701. Review of additional citations for V2 and V3 is pending Sgt. Thornton approval. SHARN FLETCHER MEDICAL UPDATE: Banner Desert Medical Center confirmed receipt of patient at 15:41 hrs. Cervical fracture (C5 non-displaced) confirmed by CT at 16:14 hrs. Patient is in stable condition as of 18:00 hrs update. This report to be supplemented with updated medical status within 48 hours.

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Fletcher)	AZ ARS §28-730	Following Too Close — dust storm/hazardous visibility	Civil Penalty
Driver V3 (Orozco)	AZ ARS §28-730	Following Too Close — dust storm/hazardous visibility	Civil Penalty
Driver V4 (Castillo)	AZ ARS §28-730	Following Too Close — entered dust storm at speed	Civil Penalty
Driver V4 (Castillo)	AZ ARS §28-701	Failure to Reduce Speed for Hazardous Conditions	Civil Penalty

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Daniel E. Vargas, Badge #8819

Investigating Officer, Phoenix Police Department Traffic Services

July 19, 2026

Date